

Enterprise. From Windows 3.1 to Windows Millennium Edition, the operating system was primarily based on the DOS system. From Windows XP the DOS technology used for the earlier operating systems was abandoned in favour of the more robust technology based on the Windows NT technology.

6.2 General Software Terms

6.2.1 AIFF

Audio Interchange File Format. An audio file format from Apple computer for storing high quality audio. This is similar to the Windows WAV (wave) audio format in both audio quality and size.

6.2.2 Alert Box

A window that pops up on your screen with warnings generated by any running application which has encountered a special condition, where you are required to be notified of the situation. An anti-virus program scanning your system, for example, would pop up an alert box if it found something harmful.

6.2.3 Application

This is a generic term for any software program that runs on the computer. Applications run within operating systems and as such cannot be used between different operating systems. That is, an application that runs in the Mac OS will not under normal circumstances run on a Windows or Linux system. There are exceptions to this rule but those are essentially feats of software engineering genius. Systems software is a special class of applications and as such should be considered to be different from applications themselves.

6.2.4 Boot

If you've ever been asked to boot up or reboot the computer and you were not exactly sure as to what they meant, here is the skinny on that! Booting the computer is nothing more than switching it on. It's been derived from the word bootstrap which